

Dashboard Guide: How to Read Each Chart

Support Agent Performance Dashboard (Tableau)

Prepared for: Aaron | Data: simulated customer support tickets, 1,924 rows, 9 agents

This guide explains what each part of the dashboard shows, how to read the colors, what stands out, and what to be careful about. Values come from the MySQL queries and were checked on the raw CSV. Items marked (†) were calculated outside MySQL.

1. The Layout in One Look

Row	What is there	Question it answers
Title	Support Agent Performance Dashboard	-
1. KPI cards	Total tickets, Fixed by agent, Fixed rate, Escalation rate, Avg. first response, Avg. resolution time, Avg. CSAT	How is the team doing overall?
2. Agents	Escalation rate, fixed rate and CSAT by agent, next to the Agent profile table and its legends	How do the agents compare?
3. Priority	Average resolution time by agent and priority, next to Priority mix by agent	Are agents compared fairly?
4. Channel and category	Channel mix by agent, next to average resolution time by channel and category	Does channel or category explain the gaps?
5. Top 10	The ten slowest channel and category combinations	Where is resolution slowest?

Hover over any bar or cell to see its tooltip, which includes the ticket count behind the number.

2. Color Key

Where	Color	Meaning
KPI cards	Red number	The Escalation rate, the watch-list number. All other cards share one color.
Rate and CSAT bars	Red bar	The agent with the highest escalation rate
Rate and CSAT bars	Green bar	The agent(s) with the highest fixed rate and the highest CSAT
Agent profile	Darker color	A higher value in that column. Each column has its own scale and legend.
Priority heatmap	Blue / Brown	Blue = faster than the average for that priority, Brown = slower (scale about -6 to +6 hrs)
Priority and channel mix	One color per priority or channel	See each chart's legend. Each bar adds up to 100%.
Channel and category heatmap	Darker green	Slower average resolution time
Top 10	Orange bar	The slowest combination

3. KPI Cards

Item	Detail
Shows	1,924 tickets; 1,280 fixed by the agent; 92.0% fixed rate; 8.0% escalation rate; 12.1 hrs average first response; 58.4 hrs average resolution time; 2.7 / 5 average CSAT.
How to read	Fixed rate and escalation rate use the tickets that reached an outcome (fixed + escalated = 1,392), so they add up to 100%. The 532 tickets still open are not in those rates.
Stands out	About 28% of tickets (532 of 1,924) are still open. Fixed + escalated + open = 1,924.
Be careful	CSAT is blank for escalated and open tickets, so the 2.7 covers only the 1,280 fixed tickets. A full explanation of each formula is in the KPI Guide.

4. Escalation Rate, Fixed Rate and CSAT by Agent

Item	Detail
Shows	Three rows of bars, one bar per agent: average escalation rate, fixed rate and CSAT.
How to read	Red marks the highest escalation rate. Green marks the highest fixed rate and the highest CSAT. Taller is higher; the axes start at zero.
Stands out	Raj P has the highest escalation rate (11.2%, 17 of 152 tickets with an outcome). Omar F has the highest fixed rate (95.5%). Elena V and Daniel N tie for the highest CSAT (2.9).
Be careful	The bars look alike because the differences are small: fixed rates run 88.8% to 95.5%, escalation rates 4.5% to 11.2% (on 7 to 17 escalations each), and CSAT 2.6 to 2.9 on a 1 to 5 scale. Highlighting the top agent does not mean the others are weak.

5. Agent Profile Table

Item	Detail
Shows	One row per agent with response time (hrs), resolution time (hrs), CSAT, fixed rate (%) and escalated rate (%). The legends to the right show each column's range, for example resolution time from 51.7 to 63.5.
How to read	Read the numbers first. The shading is a quick guide: every column has its own scale, and darker means a higher value.
Direction matters	Lower is better for response time, resolution time and escalated rate. Higher is better for CSAT and fixed rate. A dark cell is good in some columns and bad in others.
Stands out	Omar F: best fixed rate (95.5) but only 2.6 CSAT. Daniel N: fastest resolution (51.7 hrs) and 2.9 CSAT. Raj P: lowest fixed rate (88.8) and highest escalated rate (11.2).
Be careful	The best agent on one metric is not the best on the others. Across 1,280 rated tickets, CSAT has almost no relationship with response or resolution time (†), so speed does not predict satisfaction in this data.

6. Average Resolution Time by Agent and Priority (Heatmap)

Item	Detail
Shows	Each cell is an agent's average resolution time (hrs) for one priority level. The color shows how far that cell is from the average for the same priority.
How to read	Compare agents within one column only. Blue means faster than the others on that priority, brown means slower. The numbers show the actual hours.
Stands out	Resolution times differ hugely by priority: Critical tickets take about 7 to 10 hours, High about 22 to 25, Medium about 49 to 57 and Low about 99 to 111. No agent is the fastest or slowest across all four. Priya S is fastest on Low (98.8 hrs) but slowest on High (25.1 hrs).
Be careful	The Critical column rests on few tickets per agent (as few as 4 for Yuki T), so a handful of tickets can move a cell. The tooltip shows the ticket count.

7. Priority Mix by Agent

Item	Detail
Shows	For each agent, the share of their tickets in each priority level. Each bar adds up to 100%.
How to read	A longer segment means a larger share of that agent's tickets. Compare segments of the same color across agents.
Stands out	Daniel N has the largest share of Critical tickets (10.8%) and the smallest share of Low ones (26.4%). Yuki T is the reverse: 4.4% Critical and 31.5% Low.
Why it matters	Critical tickets resolve quickly and Low tickets slowly, so an agent with more Critical and fewer Low tickets has a lower overall average. This is a large part of why Daniel N looks fastest overall and Yuki T slowest.

8. Channel Mix by Agent

Item	Detail
Shows	For each agent, the share of their tickets that came through each channel. Each bar adds up to 100%.
How to read	Compare the same color across agents. The thin twitter_dm slice (about 2% to 5%) is too narrow to label; hover over it for its value.
Stands out	Every agent has about 24% to 30% of tickets by email and 20% to 25% by chat. The mixes are very similar.
Why it matters	Because agents get nearly the same channel mix, channel does not explain why some agents have longer resolution times. In a rough what-if check (+), priority mix could account for about 8.8 of the 11.8-hour gap between agents, channel mix about 0.5 hours and category mix about 0.9.

9. Average Resolution Time by Channel and Category (Heatmap)

Item	Detail
Shows	Each cell is the average resolution time (hrs) for one channel and category combination.
How to read	Darker green means slower. Blank cells have fewer than 10 tickets and are hidden because their averages are unreliable. A blank cell does not mean zero.
Stands out	Delivery / Shipping is dark across five channels (chat 67.6, email 64.6, twitter_dm 72.0, web_form 74.6, whatsapp 64.8). The darkest cell is whatsapp and General Inquiry at 88.5 hrs.
Be careful	The darkest cell rests on exactly 10 tickets, so a repeated pattern (such as Delivery / Shipping) is more trustworthy than any single cell. The filter also hides phone and Delivery / Shipping, which averages 88.8 hrs on 9 tickets, so the cut-off changes which cell looks slowest.

10. Top 10 Slowest Channel and Category Combinations

Item	Detail
Shows	The ten slowest combinations among those with at least 10 tickets. Labels at the bar ends show average resolution hours, and the tooltip shows the ticket count.
How to read	Longer bars are slower. The orange bar is the slowest.
Stands out	1. whatsapp / General Inquiry 88.5 hrs (10 tickets); 2. helpdesk_portal / Feature Request 75.3 (13); 3. web_form / Delivery / Shipping 74.6 (16); 4. twitter_dm / Delivery / Shipping 72.0 (10); 5. whatsapp / Feature Request 71.5 (25). Feature Request and Delivery / Shipping appear repeatedly.
Be careful	Four of the top five rest on 10 to 16 tickets. Use it to decide where to look next, not to conclude that a channel is slow.

11. Reading the Dashboard as a Story

- **Start with the KPI cards:** 1,924 tickets, 92.0% fixed, 8.0% escalated, 58.4 hrs to resolve, 2.7 / 5 CSAT.
- **Compare the agents:** the differences are modest, and no agent is best on every measure.
- **Check fairness:** resolution time depends heavily on priority, and agents receive different priority mixes. Compare agents within a priority level.
- **Test channel and category:** channel mix is similar for everyone and does not explain the gap. Delivery / Shipping and Feature Request are slow across several channels.
- **Decide carefully:** use the results to choose which tickets to review, not to rank people.

12. Limitations

- The dataset is **simulated**, so results describe this data, not real agents.
- Many groups are small (4 to 17 Critical tickets per agent, 7 to 17 escalations per agent). Small groups can shift with a few tickets.

- CSAT is blank for escalated and open tickets, and it is unclear what resolution time means for an escalated ticket.
- 76 ticket IDs are missing from the data (2,000 described, 1,924 present). They are also missing from the original downloaded file (checked for TKT-00021), so they come from the source, not from cleaning.
- The (t) checks were calculated outside MySQL and are rough estimates, not statistical tests.

13. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Fixed by agent	A ticket that is not escalated and has the status Resolved or Closed
Escalated	A ticket handed to engineering
Still open	A ticket that is not escalated and has the status Open or In Progress
Fixed rate / Escalation rate	Fixed (or escalated) tickets divided by fixed + escalated tickets
First response time	Hours from ticket creation to the first reply
Resolution time	Hours from creation to resolution (blank for open tickets)
CSAT	Customer satisfaction score from 1 to 5 (blank for escalated and open tickets)
Priority	Critical, High, Medium or Low
Mix	The share of an agent's tickets in each group, shown as percentages that add up to 100%